

natural-looking hues. Blues, greens, and reds retain their distinctiveness without over-saturation. In comparison, the Arc 5's warmer bias tends to mute greens and distort cooler tones, though its screen uniformity is excellent, producing consistent brightness across the frame with minimal vignetting.

HDR Performance

Both projectors support HDR10 and HLG, but given their brightness levels, the HDR benefits are modest. The Arc 7 handles HDR content better, preserving contrast and depth without colour clipping. Dolby Vision support is absent, but its omission doesn't hurt much as neither projector has the peak luminance to fully utilise it. Instead, HDR here serves as a gentle enhancement rather than a dramatic effect. Colours remain faithful, and tone mapping avoids the crushed blacks or overblown highlights typical of cheap HDR implementations.

AUDIO PERFORMANCE

Both models integrate Dolby Audio-tuned speakers, but again, the Arc 7 pulls ahead with dual 8W drivers and a passive radiator, delivering surprisingly rich and room-filling sound. For small to mid-sized rooms, it's more than enough. In use, dialogues are crisp, and music playback has decent body. The Arc 5's 5W speaker performs admirably for its size but lacks the depth and separation of the larger sibling.

HDMI ARC, Bluetooth 5.1, and 3.5 mm outputs offer flexibility for connecting soundbars or external systems, and latency over Bluetooth remains minimal for most streaming scenarios.

SOFTWARE AND CONTENT

This is where Lumio decisively differentiates itself from the cluttered projector market. Both the Arc 5 and Arc 7 run official Google TV, not the clunky AOSP variants seen in cheap imports. You get native Netflix certification, Play Store access, Chromecast, and Google Assistant voice controls out of the box.

Lumio's in-house TLDR interface adds an extra layer of convenience,



surfacing trending music, sports scores, and playlists without jumping between apps. In day-to-day use, performance is smooth and lag-free, thanks to the MTK9630 chip paired with 2GB RAM and 16GB storage.

VIEWING EXPERIENCE

In a dim or dark room, both projectors deliver a satisfying cinematic experience, with the Arc 7 clearly offering more brightness headroom and superior tonal balance. For most users, the Arc 5 is perfectly suited for bedrooms or hostel setups. It's compact, consistent, and makes big-screen viewing effortless.

The Arc 7, meanwhile, feels like the more mature sibling. It's brighter, more accurate, and with sound powerful enough to fill larger spaces. It's not meant to rival Rs 1-lakh projectors, but for its price range, the overall design and image quality are impressive.

VERDICT

The Lumio Arc 5 and Arc 7 mark a promising new chapter for made-in-India home projectors. Both nail the fundamentals, ease of use, Google TV integration, and reliability, while offering thoughtful engineering touches

like auto keystone and sealed optics that genuinely improve usability.

If you're buying your first projector under Rs 20,000, the Lumio Arc 5 is an easy recommendation. It's affordable, compact, delivers a cinematic experience unmatched in its segment and is ideal for dark-room binge sessions and casual entertainment.

For those who can stretch the budget, the Lumio Arc 7 elevates the experience considerably. It's brighter, more colour-accurate, and backed by better audio, making it a genuine all-in-one home theatre option for small and mid-sized rooms.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: MediaTek 9630 | RAM: 2 GB | Storage: 16 GB | Resolution: 1920x1080 | Screen Size: 40" - 100" | Throw Ratio: 1.25:1 | Audio: Dolby 5.1 AC3, E-AC3 | Power Supply: 120W | OS: Google TV Android 11

CONTACT

Lumio India | Telephone: +91 7204973629 | Email: support@lumio.co.in | Website: https://lumio.co.in/support

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